

Ordering Three Amounts from Least to Greatest

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 3, 5, 8

2. 4, 7, 9

3. 3, 6, 10

4. 7, 11, 13

5. 12, 20, 21

6. 14, 40, 41

7. 11, 6, 8, 11

8. 15, 12, 12, 15, 20

1. Apples on three plates. Count each plate one object at a time: Plate A has 5, Plate B has 8, Plate C has 3. Now find the least. Three is said first when counting (3, 5, 8), so 3 is the least and 8 is the greatest. Order: 3, 5, 8

2. Three number cards: 7, 4, 9. Count up and listen for which number is said first: 4, then 7, then 9. The number said earliest in counting order is the least. Order: 4, 7, 9

3. Ten-frames. Frame A: the top row is full (5) and one more counter sits below, so $5 + 1 = 6$. Frame B: both rows are full, so it is a full ten, 10. Frame C: 3 counters. Counting order gives 3, then 6, then 10. Order: 3, 6, 10

4. Cube trains. Count the cubes in each train: Train A has 13 cubes, Train B has 7 cubes, Train C has 11 cubes. Train B is the shortest train, so 7 is the least; Train A is the longest, so 13 is the greatest. Order: 7, 11, 13

5. Books on three shelves. The three amounts are 20 (red), 12 (blue) and 21 (green). Compare the tens first: 12 has 1 ten, while 20 and 21 each have 2 tens, so 12 is the least. Then compare 20 and 21: same 2 tens, and 0 ones is fewer than 1 one, so 20 comes before 21. Order: 12, 20, 21

6. Buttons in three jars. The three amounts are 41 (Mia), 14 (Sam) and 40 (Joy). Look at the tens digit, not just the digits used: 14 has only 1 ten, while 41 and 40 each have 4 tens, so 14 is the least. Between 40 and 41, the ones digit decides: 0 ones is fewer than 1 one. Order: 14, 40, 41

7. Stickers. Step 1 — find Ben's amount. Ben has 3 more than Ana's 8, so Ben has $8 + 3 = \boxed{11}$ stickers.
Step 2 — now all three amounts are known: Ana 8, Ben 11, Cal 6. Counting order gives 6, then 8, then 11. Order: 6, 8, 11

8. Team points. Step 1 — find each team's total. Team Red: $10 + 5 = \boxed{15}$ points. Team Gold: $9 + 3 = \boxed{12}$ points. Team Blue already has its total, 20 points.

Step 2 — order the three totals. Compare the tens: 12 and 15 each have 1 ten, 20 has 2 tens, so 20 is the greatest. Between 12 and 15, 2 ones is fewer than 5 ones, so 12 is the least.

Order:

$\boxed{12, 15, 20}$